



THREE TOOLS. ONE EVIDENCE-LED PROCESS.

Your STR Research Toolkit

Choose a market. Check a property. Test the numbers.

A guide to the calculator, buy box checklist and 100-market directory. Start here before editing the examples.

EDITION

21 September 2026
Design revision

FORMAT

Field guide + Excel
U.S. short-term rentals

USE

Educational tools
Not investment advice

Read this first

Work from evidence, not an attractive headline.

This toolkit is for people researching U.S. short-term rentals. It supports rental arbitrage and property ownership. Both need property-level proof and a complete cost model.

What this toolkit is not

It is not a list of approved investments. It does not clear permits, quote a mortgage or prepare a tax return. The examples are not researched properties.

THE ORDER MATTERS

Market short list → written permissions → matched comps and cost quotes → calculator → evidence checklist → professional review.

Read the date correctly

Research date: 21 September 2026. Market observations retain their own dates. This visual redesign does not renew the original tax-law or local-regulation review.

Keep a record for each property

Save a separate calculator copy. Store source dates, written quotes and permission documents beside it. Write down the facts that remain unknown.

Education only. Seek advice from qualified tax, legal, lending and insurance professionals. No bookings, permits, deductions or investment results are guaranteed.

Contents

Find the page you need. Keep the workbook open nearby.

01	Choose the right tool	3
02	Use the calculator in five passes	4
	Your one-page next step	5
	Notes, sources and checks	6
	Before you use the files	7

HOW TO READ THIS

Read Part 01 to choose a file. Follow Part 02 for the calculator. Use the one-page plan to record the next action and who owns it.

PART

01 Choose the right tool

Each file has a different job.

TOOL	USE IT TO
Deal Analysis Calculator STR-Deal-Analysis-Calculator.xlsx	Test arbitrage or ownership. Model revenue, full costs, financing, cash flow, break-even and scenarios. Use tax estimates last.
Buy Box Checklist PDF + Excel	Work through 55 checks. Track evidence and next actions. Score the deal only after permission and safety gates are resolved.
100 U.S. STR Markets PDF + Excel	Compare public benchmarks and research hypotheses. Read source dates, rule findings, missing data and selected housing/rent context.

How the workbooks look

VISUAL CUE	MEANING
Green-tinted cells	Your editable assumptions or notes
Cream and ivory results	Calculated or source-backed information
Gold attention flags	Unknown facts or items to investigate
Rose warnings	A failure, loss or stopped operating plan

Some attention flags sit in editable cells. Read the field label and dropdown. Do not overwrite calculated results.

DO THIS WEEK

- ☐ Open Instructions in the calculator.
- ☐ Choose arbitrage or ownership for one property.
- ☐ Save a working copy with that property's name.

Use the calculator in five passes

A reliable input matters more than a polished output.

1. Choose one business model

Arbitrage starts with a lease. Ownership starts with a purchase and, often, a loan. Their startup cash and payment obligations differ.

2. Replace every example input

Enter your property and written lease or financing terms. Quote management, utilities, cleaning, insurance and repairs. The original examples deliberately show losses after full costs.

3. Build the calendar

Flat mode uses annual inputs. Monthly mode uses all 12 months in Seasonality. Include unavailable nights, average stay, guest fees and actual turnover costs.

4. Review the downside

The conservative case cuts ADR by 15% and occupancy by 10 percentage points. It raises fixed and unit turnover costs by 10%.

Also test a launch delay, insurance shock, assessment and loss of legal operation. Monthly averages can hide a weak season.

5. Review tax estimates last

Check pre-tax viability first. Bonus eligibility and other-income loss offsets default to unconfirmed. Take the assumptions and documents to a qualified tax professional.

DO THIS WEEK

- ☐ Replace the property and operating assumptions.
- ☐ Read the conservative case and record cash flow.
- ☐ Write three questions for your professional review.

Your one-page next step

Choose one property or one market question. Define the evidence you need before moving on.

RECORD

YOUR NOTES

Property / market / operating
model

One question to answer first

Document or person that can
answer it

Base case / downside case to test

Condition required before signing

Next action / person / deadline

☐ I saved a separate working copy.

☐ I checked the source dates and missing-data notes.

☐ I have not counted an unconfirmed tax benefit as cash.

REVIEWER / SIGNATURE

DATE

Notes, sources and checks

Research carried forward

AREA	ORIGINAL COVERAGE
Market performance	AirDNA and selected Rabbu. 99 ADR/occupancy and 98 historical annual-revenue benchmarks. 13 snapshots are undated.
Housing and rent	15 dated home-value and 16 rent observations from Zillow. Definitions and dates remain separate.
Local regulations	31 official reviews, including 2 partial county reviews. 69 local checks are unresolved. All 100 need parcel review.
Tax references	IRS Notice 2026-11 and Publications 925, 946 and 527. Tax eligibility and loss use depend on the taxpayer's facts.

What the original tax model leaves out

It assumes illustrative 100% business use. State depreciation is entered separately. NIIT, AMT, full loss limitations, mixed personal use and sale taxes are not fully modeled.

Original tests and this design revision

The original calculator includes a log of 152 numerical assertions. Four original scorecard checks tested hard-gate overrides. Those results remain in the workbook.

This revision checks formula preservation, example results, dropdowns and exported files. The PDFs are rendered and checked for page overflow. These checks do not validate future assumptions.

Primary references

[IRS Notice 2026-11](#) · [Pub. 925](#) · [Pub. 946](#) · [Pub. 527](#). Market and official local links remain in the market workbook.

Before you use the files

Working with Excel

Use a current Excel desktop version for the most consistent experience. The files have no macros or live feeds. Recalculate after importing into another spreadsheet app.

The workbooks specify Newsreader and Instrument Sans. If those fonts are not installed, your spreadsheet app may substitute a font. PDF typography is embedded.

Keep the model's definitions

Revenue includes host cleaning and guest fees. Pass-through lodging taxes and the platform's guest service fee are excluded.

NOI excludes debt, income tax, depreciation and CapEx reserves. Ownership cash flow then deducts principal, interest and CapEx reserves. Startup cash includes deposits and reserves.

Break-even holds the cost structure and average stay constant. An occupancy rate above 100% cannot work. N/M means undefined, not meaningful or infeasible.

The decision still needs evidence

Use post-purchase tax estimates and bindable insurance quotes. Read the lease, loan and management terms. Refresh local rules immediately before signing, closing or listing.

KEEP YOUR OWN AUDIT TRAIL

Save the sources, dates and assumptions used for each deal. A good-looking tool cannot make a weak assumption reliable.

These are educational estimates, not investment, legal, tax, accounting or lending advice. Outcomes are not guaranteed. Review the specific property and taxpayer facts with qualified professionals.